AN OPEN CONVERSATION ABOUT DATA, MARKETING & AI

Marketing Measurement From Attribution to Influence

Why we measure · What MMM tells us · Where AI takes us next

With a brief Google Meridian / JupyterLab example

Universidad Galileo | October 2026

What actually makes somebody buy?

A conversion is the end of a journey — not the whole journey.



Question: which touchpoint deserves the credit?

Attribution: who gets credit for the conversion?

YouTube ad → Google search → Facebook reminder → Purchase

Last-click attribution

Google Search or Facebook might receive most of the credit, depending on the final tracked touchpoint.

The missing question

Would that person have purchased anyway, even if the advertising had not happened?

Attribution assigns credit. Incrementality asks what changed because of marketing.

The real business question: did marketing change the outcome?

Two imagined worlds, one business decision.

WITH CAMPAIGN

1,200

conversions

WITHOUT CAMPAIGN

1,000

conversions

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

Incremental effect: +200 conversions

Why marketing is hard to measure

Marketing does not happen in a controlled environment.

HOLIDAYS

Seasonal demand

COMPETITORS

Their ads and offers

PROMOTIONS

Discounts and pricing

ECONOMY

Income and demand

PRODUCT

Stock and availability

MEDIA

Campaign activity

The skill is not adding more variables. It is separating relevant drivers from noise.

What Marketing Mix Modeling does

MMM tries to separate sales or conversions into understandable drivers.

BASELINE

What would likely happen without paid media

MARKETING

Additional outcome attributed to campaigns

OTHER DRIVERS

Promotions, demand, holidays and more

What do we get? Better budget questions — not a perfect crystal ball.

Practical implementation: let’s open JupyterLab

LIVE NOTEBOOK · 5–8 MINUTES

01 Synthetic data: Search · Meta · YouTube

02 Estimated channel contributions

03 Response curves and diminishing returns

04 Change spend → compare incremental revenue

Ask the students

If I increase YouTube spend by 20%, will revenue rise by 20%?

Show, don’t derive.

Two ways to model uncertainty

Frequentist

Estimate effects from data using a fixed model. Often fast and straightforward; uncertainty is interpreted through repeated-sampling procedures.

Bayesian

Combine the observed data with explicit prior assumptions. Report distributions over plausible effects and support probability-based decisions.

Why Meridian today? **Useful prior evidence + decision uncertainty + timely tool for new graduates**

What changes when AI becomes part of the customer journey?

AI-GENERATED OFFERS

Personalized recommendations and dynamic content

AI-MEDIATED DISCOVERY

Search, assistants, and recommendations influence choice

TRUST IS FRAGILE

Hallucinations and unsupported claims can do real damage

MEASUREMENT MUST EVOLVE

Track behavior, experiments, customer outcomes, and trust

My question: where is the actual value — and how do we prove it?

A thought-provoking paper: from the 7Ps to the 7Gs

Marketing mix rebuilding for the age of generative AI

Makrydakis · Spiliotopoulos · Michalakelis · Lymperi | 2026

The 7G idea

Generative offers · Value calibration
Access architectures · Persuasion systems
Agency networks · Experience flows
Trust signals

What interests me

It asks the right questions about influence, trust and AI-shaped decisions — but does not finish the practical measurement problem.

How do we prove AI helps customers and businesses — without damaging trust?

Read the paper · DOI: 10.33545/26648792.2026.v8.i1a.597